02 | LADDER OF INFERENCE | FLYER

Ladder of Inference: Check the Facts

Slow down before you jump to a conclusion

We move from "what happened" to "what I'll do about it" very fast. Each step up the ladder adds a little of our own interpretation.



START HERE • Read from 1 at the bottom to 7 at the top.

Climb back down

Ask yourself: What do I actually know? What did I add? What question would test it? Get the answer, then decide or escalate.

Watch for the feedback loop: what you already believe changes what you notice next.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."